Pakistan about not using US equipment against India. Furthermore, they asserted that the US would not allow Pakistan to attack India.[217]

The US also offered reassurance about the pacts. Indian officials approvingly noted reports that the US had specified that its participation in the Southeast Asia Treaty Organization was directed against communist aggression. They noted American opposition to Pakistani attempts to discuss Kashmir at Southeast Asia Treaty Organization and Central Treaty Organization meetings.[218] Later, after the Pakistani prime minister publicly called for Central Treaty Organization countries to be equipped with nuclear weapons, Nehru publicly stated that he was "gratified" that the US turned down the Pakistani demand.[219]

American officials also refused to give in to Pakistani demands to withhold aid from India to push it toward a Kashmir settlement. Washington hoped for improvement in India-Pakistan relations—allowing those countries to focus on development and making it easier to get aid for them through Congress—but Dulles asserted to Pakistani officials that US aid to India "was needed to prevent India from going the way of China."[220]

Overall, during this period both sides tried to deal with their differences in a better way. One was by handling them with care and, to the extent possible, discreetly. Nehru, for example, was careful to keep most criticism and concern private.[221] If the government was going to express concern about any international issues publicly, his instructions were to do so "without going too far."[222] Dutt privately told off diplomats who made unnecessarily harsh statements.[223] Nehru also tried to temper public criticism. For instance, he refused to join the criticism of Dulles's reported disinclination to invite India to a summit, saying that Indians should accept the secretary of state's reasonable explanation.[224]

The second way was by de-emphasizing differences. Dulles bluntly noted that India's success was so crucial that it "over[rode] any areas of difference."[225] And Eisenhower and Radhakrishnan concurred that there were "differences but that they were not vital."[226]